

LEARN ABOUT QUALITY



WHAT ARE QUALITY STANDARDS?.

[Quality Glossary Definition: Standard](#)

Quality standards are defined as documents that provide requirements, specifications, guidelines, or characteristics that can be used consistently to ensure that materials, products, processes, and services are fit for their purpose.

Standards provide organizations with the shared vision, understanding, procedures, and vocabulary needed to meet the expectations of their stakeholders. Because standards present precise descriptions and terminology, they offer an objective and authoritative basis for organizations and consumers around the world to communicate and conduct business.



Principles of Quality Standards

WHO USES QUALITY STANDARDS?

Organizations turn to standards for guidelines, definitions, and procedures that help them achieve objectives such as:

- Satisfying their customers' quality requirements
- Ensuring their products and services are safe
- Complying with regulations
- Meeting environmental objectives
- Protecting products against climatic or other adverse conditions
- Ensuring that internal processes are defined and controlled

Use of quality standards is voluntary, but may be expected by certain groups of [stakeholders](#). Additionally, some organizations or government agencies may require suppliers and partners to use a specific standard as a condition of doing business.

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ASQ QUALITY STANDARDS

Topic:	Standard:
Quality Management	ISO 9000 ISO 9001
Auditing	ISO 19011
Environmental Management	ISO 14000 ISO 14001
Risk Management	ISO 31011
Social Responsibility	ISO 26000
Sampling by Attributes	Z1.4
Sampling by Variables	Z1.9
Food Safety	ISO 22000
Learn more about ANSI standards	

WHAT'S NEW IN ISO STANDARDS?



[ISO 19011:2018](#)

The 2018 revision of ISO 19011, the international standard that specifies guidelines for auditing management systems and managing an audit program, is available. **Purchase [ASQ/ANSI/ISO 19011:2018](#).**



[ISO 9001:2015](#) and [ISO 9000:2015](#)

The 2015 revisions of ISO 9001, the international standard that specifies quality management systems (QMS) requirements, and ISO 9000, which provides fundamental QMS concepts, principles, and vocabulary, are available. **Purchase [ASQ/ANSI/ISO 9001:2015](#) and [ASQ/ANSI/ISO 9000:2015](#).**



[ISO 14001:2015](#)

The 2015 revision of ISO 14001, the international standard that specifies requirements for environmental management systems, is available. **Purchase [ASQ/ANSI/ISO 14001:2015](#).**

WHY ARE STANDARDS IMPORTANT?

For businesses: Standards are important to the bottom line of every organization. Successful companies recognize standards as business tools that should be managed alongside quality, safety, intellectual property, and environmental policies. Standardization leads to lower costs by reducing redundancy, minimizing errors or [recalls](#), and reducing time to market.

For the global economy: Businesses and organizations complying to quality standards helps products, services, and personnel cross borders and also ensures that products manufactured in one country can be sold and used in another.

For consumers: Many quality management standards provide safeguards for users of products and services, but standardization can also make consumers' lives simpler. A product or service based on an international standard will be compatible with more products or services worldwide, which increases the number of choices available across the globe.

WHY STANDARDS FROM ASQ?

ASQ plays a vital role in the development of international standards. ASQ's role is to administer the U.S. Technical Advisory Groups (TAGs) that develop the most popular standards—[ISO 9001](#), [ISO 19011](#), [ISO 26000](#), and [ISO 14001](#). Additionally, ASQ produces books, articles, case studies, webcasts, training, and other supporting materials for individuals and organizations looking to improve their use of and compliance to quality standards.